



Shaka Laka Boom Boom

A powerful laser that can be used to "draw in the air" has been created by Chinese Scientists. <https://digit.in/aug22-10>

turn in Apple's favour, but there are only a handful of tracks that support this feature on Apple Music.

The highs are slightly more sparkly on the AirPods Pro but the Sony is no slouch when it comes to reproducing highs as well. Cymbals and hi-hats sound clear and detailed on both earphones. Another point in Sony's favour is the fact that you can customise the EQ via the app, so if you prefer a more neutral sound, you can tweak it within the app. The same is not true for the AirPods Pro.

Spatial audio on the AirPods Pro is a magical and immersive experience though, especially when used with head tracking turned on. Apple Music has a bunch of playlists that support spatial audio that you can listen to. Overall though, the Sony WF-1000XM4 still provides a more detailed and refined sonic experience.

Sound quality winner - Sony WF-1000XM4

MICROPHONE

The Sony WF-1000XM4 features beamforming microphones and a bone conduction sensor to pick up your voice and relay it. The AirPods Pro also features beamforming microphones and an inward-facing microphone for noise cancellation, transparency mode, and calls. While the microphones on both earbuds don't come close to external boom mics or desktop microphones, they're one of the best money can buy in the TWS form factor. Both earbuds come with their own form of wind-reduction technology as well.

In our experience, the AirPods Pro's microphone is superior in more ways than one. The microphone picks up the speaker's voice while eliminating most ambient noises. The sound picked up is clear and distortion-free as well. It also sounds extremely natural, preserving the tonality and intricacies of a speaker's voice with more precision than the Sony WF-1000XM4 does. The Sony WF-1000XM4's microphone also relays clear and loud voices on calls and during recordings. However, they don't sound nearly as pristine as on the AirPods. Additionally, Sony

picks up much more ambient sound in noisy environments compared to the AirPods Pro.

Microphone winner - AirPods Pro

ACTIVE NOISE CANCELLATION

At the heart of the Sony WF-1000XM4's noise cancelling abilities is the company's integrated V1 chip and the array of microphones. The AirPods Pro has two microphones on each bud; one on the outside to detect incoming ambient noise and one on the inside to detect noise that makes it through the seal. This sound detected by both earphones is then cancelled out using anti-noise which is bolstered by their respective AI algorithms. The AirPods Pro, in fact, adjusts noise cancelling 200 times per second, something that is only matched by the AirPods Max.

As a result, what you get on both the Sony WF-1000XM4 and the AirPods Pro is highly effective

especially with human voices - which it lets through pretty easily.

Both earphones also come with pressure-relieving air vents that help avoid the feeling of air being sucked out of your ears that some find uncomfortable.

Active Noise Cancellation winner - Sony WF-1000XM4

TRANSPARENCY MODE

We've said it for a while now - no one does Transparency Mode as well as Apple, period. While the Sony WF-1000XM4 are markedly improved in this department over their predecessors, they don't come close to how natural the AirPods Pro's Transparency Mode sounds. The H1 chip on the AirPods Pro works alongside the microphones to power this experience. This mode helps users be more aware of their surroundings in public areas to hear oncoming traffic or announcements in train stations or airports. Or,



noise cancelling that easily dims out constant, low-frequency sounds such as an AC's hum, an airplane's drone, and more. However, where the Sony Mark 4s shine is in cancelling out human voices and more high-pitched sounds. While the AirPods Pro also do a decent job at cancelling out these difficult frequencies, the Mark 4s handle them with a sense of confidence that's unparalleled in the TWS space. So, even in noisy office environments, you're looking at a solid 60-70 per cent of perceived noise reduction in mid and high frequencies. In contrast, the AirPods Pro struggles a bit here -

just to have a quick conversation with someone without having to take off your earphones entirely.

External sounds are amplified so you can hear them even though your music, still, the sounds never get into the territory of sounding jarring or unnatural. While Transparency Mode on the Sonys sounds pretty decent, it can get a bit jarring and unnatural because of how loud the playback is.

Transparency Mode winner - AirPods Pro

FEATURES

The Sony Headphone Connect app is possibly one of the most utilitarian and